

Registration of architects

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**Architects
Registration Board
of Victoria**



Acknowledgment of Country

We respectfully acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands where the attendees are situated and pay our respects to their Elders past and present.



OVERVIEW

- What is the ARBV?
- What is the role of the ARBV?
- Professional and Prohibited conduct
- Requirements of registration
- Professional obligations
- Pathways to registration
- Architectural Practice Examination (APE)

What is the ARBV?

- Architects Registration Board of Victoria
- Established under the Architects Act 1991 and is a statutory authority
- Regulator of the profession in Victoria
- Provides for consumer protection

What is the role of the ARBV?

- The ARBV regulates professional conduct, not design. Its focus is on consumer protection and a built environment that is compliant with building codes and standards.
- The ARBV's purpose is to protect the community interest and instil confidence in the regulation, integrity and delivery of architectural services in Victoria.

Profession Conduct and Prohibited Conduct

Professional Conduct

- Architects must demonstrate conduct that is professional.
- This includes but is not limited to fulfilling the obligations detailed in the 'Victorian Architects Code of Professional Conduct' (contained within the Architects Regulations 2026).

Prohibited Conduct

- Prohibited conduct is conduct that is a breach of the Architects Act.
- If a person or body represents themselves or allows themselves to be represented as an architect, they are in breach of the Act's prohibited conduct provisions.
- Breaches of the Act's prohibited conduct provisions may be prosecuted in the Magistrates Court of Victoria by the ARBV.

Prohibited Conduct Matter

Prohibited Conduct

- The individual previously held registration.
- The individual was prosecuted for 6 counts of holding himself and his company out as being an architect.
- The individual received \$12,000 in costs and fines to the board.

Minor Professional Conduct Matter

Professional Conduct

- The architect received a formal warning letter.
- The architect was found to have communication issues with their client.
- The architect was dismissive and sarcastic in their communication and discussed issues occurring with the client with a third party.
- The architect failed to communicate the rationale of the proposal to the client
- The architect finalized documentation without approval.
- The formal warning is recorded on the architects record of disciplinary action with the ARBV.

Serious Professional Conduct Matter

Professional Conduct

- The architect was found guilty of contravening the code.
- The architect had not provided a Client Architect Agreement.
- The architect had failed to promptly deal with a town planning permit and the permit expired.
- The architect had a number of previous disciplinary matters.
- The architect was considered a repeat offender.
- The architect's registration was cancelled.

Five key requirements:

- are a fit and proper person;
- have passed a prescribed course of study;
- have been engaged for no less than 2 years on practical architectural work and can demonstrate that you have attained a standard of professional practice satisfactory to the ARBV;
- covered by the required professional indemnity insurance (PII); and
- paying the relevant registration fees.

Requirements
of registration

Registration

Regulatory tool that controls entry to the profession

- Architects Act 1991 provides for
 - Natural persons to be registered as architects
 - Partnerships and companies to be granted approval
- Two classes of registration
 - Practising
 - For architects who intend to provide architectural services
 - Non-practising
 - For architects who do not intend to provide architectural services
 - May be taking a break from work or the industry, or seeking to retain registration for personal rather than professional purposes

Classes of Registration

Pathways to registration

There are 3 main pathways to registration:

- Architectural Practice Examination
- Experienced Practitioner Assessment
- Mutual Recognition

The Architectural Practice Examination (APE)

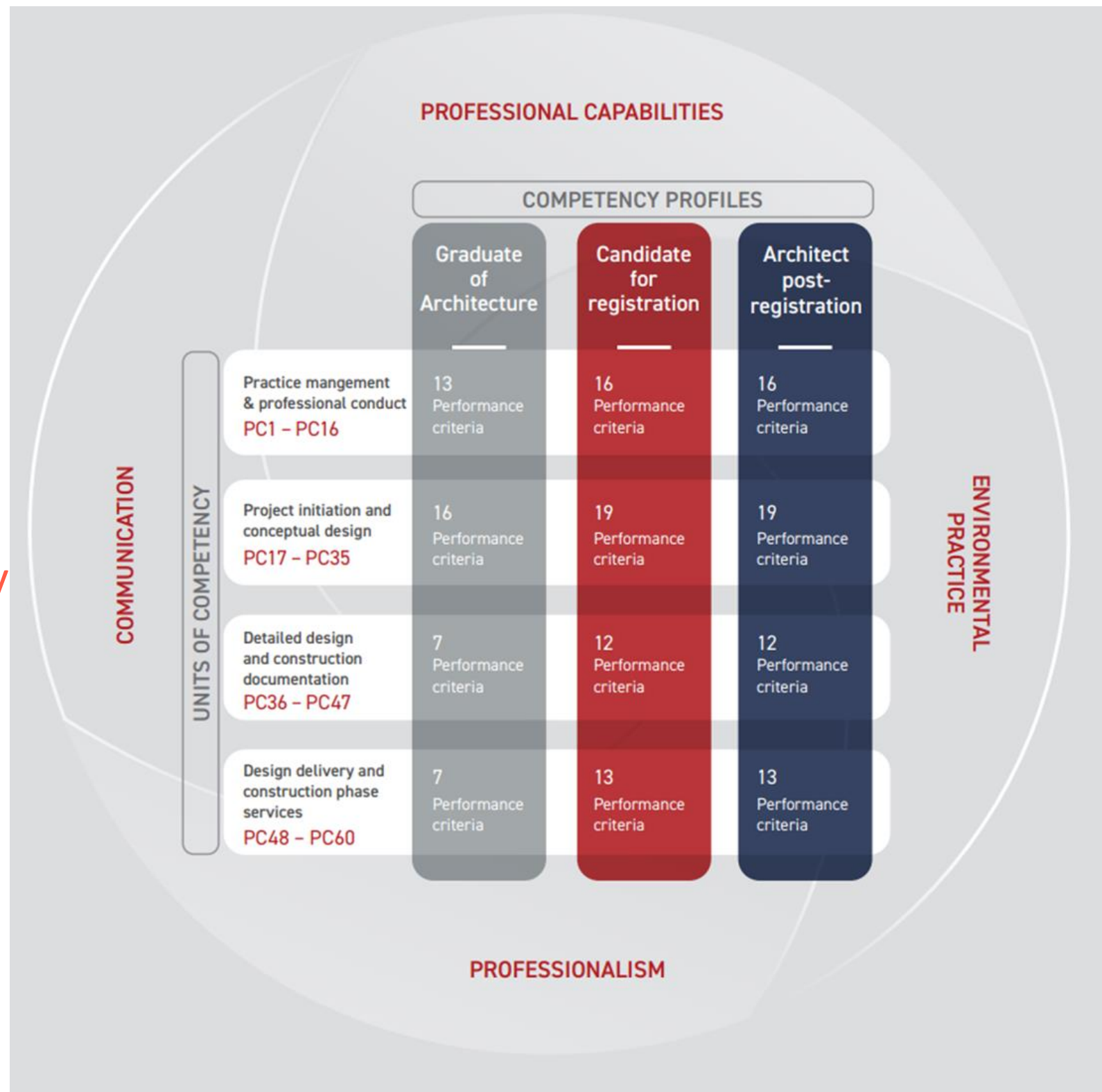
The APE is administered by the Architects Accreditation Council of Australia (AACA) on behalf of the ARBV and other state and territory architect registration boards.

The APE is the most common pathway to registration as an architect in Victoria.

The APE is separate from registration, it is a pre-registration exam.

Coaching courses for the APE are not compulsory, accredited by the AACA or affiliated with ARBV.

NSCA Competency Profiles



PERFORMANCE CRITERIA FOR PRACTICE MANAGEMENT AND PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

This unit of competency encompasses a holistic understanding of the organisation of the profession and business of architecture, with the objective of providing value through sustainable, timely and effective professional services in accordance with the ethical and legal obligations of an architect to clients, colleagues, employees and to broader communities.

	On graduation from an architecture program — a graduate will	At the point of registration — a candidate will	Post registration — an architect will
PC 1	Understand the regulatory requirements and obligations pertaining to practice as an architect, including professional codes of conduct and obligations for continuing professional development and professional indemnity insurance.	Demonstrate understanding of the regulatory requirements and obligations pertaining to practice as an architect, including legislation, professional codes of conduct, and obligations for continuing professional development and professional indemnity insurance.	Comply with the regulatory requirements and obligations pertaining to practice as an architect, including legislation, professional codes of conduct, obligations for continuing professional development and professional indemnity insurance.
PC 2	Understand the role of quality assurance systems in facilitating efficient and timely delivery of architectural services.	Be able to identify practice resources and apply practice methods and quality assurance systems within an ethical practice management framework to comply with and facilitate efficient, consistent and timely delivery of architectural services.	Implement practice resources and apply ethical employment practice methods and quality assurance systems to facilitate efficient, consistent and timely delivery of architectural services.
PC 3	Understand the principles of project planning, considering implications for Country, environmental sustainability, communities, stakeholders and project costs.	Demonstrate understanding of the principles of project planning, considering implications for Country, environmental sustainability, communities, stakeholders and project costs.	Apply principles of project planning, considering implications for Country, environmental sustainability, communities, stakeholders and project costs.
PC 4		Be able to apply principles of project and staff planning and resource costs to establish realistic and achievable timeframes.	
PC 5	Understand the essential elements of a client architect agreement, across the range of procurement methods and the different scales and types of project.	Demonstrate understanding of the essential elements of a client architect agreement across the range of procurement methods; and be able to explain appropriateness of different agreements in relation to scale and type of project, including alternatives for partial services and the engagement of secondary and sub-consultants.	Be able to apply essential elements of a client architect agreement across the range of procurement methods in relation to their appropriateness to the scale and type of the project, including alternatives for partial services and the engagement of secondary and sub-consultants.
PC 6	Understand appropriate processes for reporting and varying the scope of services provided by an architect.	Demonstrate understanding of appropriate processes for reporting and varying the scope of services provided by an architect.	Be able to apply appropriate processes for reporting and varying the scope of services provided by an architect.
PC 7	Understand appropriate processes for clear and consistent communication with clients and relevant stakeholders throughout a project, including obtaining approvals from clients and stakeholders.	Apply and follow processes for clear and consistent communication with clients and relevant stakeholders throughout the project, including obtaining approvals from clients and stakeholders.	
PC 8	Understand how to implement culturally responsive and meaningful engagement processes that respect the importance of Country and reciprocal relationships with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples across architectural services.	Be able to implement culturally responsive and meaningful engagement processes that respect the importance of Country and reciprocal relationships with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples across architectural services.	
PC 9	Understand contemporary and emerging building procurement methods. This involves identifying the most appropriate form of delivery for a project, including associated risks, mitigation and adaptation strategies, and understanding appropriate construction and consultant contracts and agreements.	Demonstrate understanding of contemporary and emerging building procurement methods. This involves identifying the most appropriate form of delivery for a project, including associated risks, mitigation and adaptation strategies, and integrating appropriate construction contracts and consultancy contracts and/or agreements.	Be able to apply contemporary and emerging building procurement methods. This involves identifying the most appropriate form of delivery for a project, including risks, mitigation and adaptation strategies, and integrating appropriate construction contracts and consultancy contracts and/or agreements.
PC 10	Understand the whole life carbon implications of procurement methods, materials, components and construction systems.	Demonstrate understanding of the whole life carbon implications of procurement methods, materials, components and construction systems.	
PC 11		Be able to assess, recommend and/or select an appropriate procurement process, with consideration for its impact on all phases of a project – including design, documentation and project delivery – and provide advice to the client in terms of the level of scope of service for consultants.	
PC 12	Understand how relevant building codes, standards and planning controls apply across architectural practice, including climate change implications, the principles of fire safety, and barriers to universal access.	Provide independent, culturally responsive and objective advice in accordance with relevant building codes, standards, technical specifications and guidelines, and planning regulations, including climate change implications, across all aspects of architectural practice.	
PC 13	Have knowledge of documentation processes that facilitate project delivery appropriate to selected procurement processes.	Be able to identify and apply strategies, programming and processes for documentation through all project stages to facilitate project delivery, as appropriate to selected procurement processes.	
PC 14		Be able to identify and apply construction services provisions and/or construction administration systems needed to fulfil all obligations appropriate to the procurement process in accordance with the terms of the agreement.	
PC 15	Understand legal and ethical obligations relating to copyright, moral rights, authorship of cultural knowledge and intellectual property requirements across architectural services.	Comply with legal and ethical obligations relating to legislated requirements in relation to copyright, moral rights, authorship of cultural knowledge and intellectual property requirements across architectural services.	
PC 16	Understand risk management and mitigation principles and strategies – including safety in design, project risk, requirement for resilience from the impacts of climate change and appropriate insurances – across architectural services.	Be able to apply risk management and mitigation strategies – including safety in design, project risk, requirement for resilience from the impacts of climate change and appropriate insurances – across architectural services.	

Part 1 – Logbook and Statement of Practical Experience

Candidates must complete a minimum of 3300 hours mandatory experience and have 2 years current practical experience.

The required 35 Performance Criteria for the APE are:

- Practice Management and professional conduct:
PCs 1, 2, 7, 11, 12, 13, 14, 16
- Project Initiation and Conceptual Design: PCs 19, 20, 21, 23, 24, 33, 35
- Detailed Design and Construction Documentation:
PCs 37, 38, 39, 41, 42, 44, 45, 46, 47
- Design Delivery and Construction Phase Services:
PCs 48, 49, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59

Part 2 – National Examination Paper (NEP)

The NEP assesses candidates' professional knowledge, through application of performance criteria in the National Standard of Competency for Architects.

- 120-minute scenario-based examination.
- 80 multiple-choice question.
- “Closed Book” exam, no notes or summary sheets may be taken into the exam.

Part 3 – Examination by Interview

During the interview you need to demonstrate and communicate adequate practical application and/or experience of the National Standard of Competency for Architects.

The questions asked may be outside the candidate's direct area of knowledge and the questions could be based on hypothetical situations.

The interview is approximately 45 – 60 minutes long.

QUESTIONS?

If you have any questions, you
can contact the ARBV via email
registrar@arbv.vic.gov.au